the organs, perish at death, and that their tissues retain none of the properties assumed to belong to them except they are acted upon from without, is a sufficient refutation of the fallacy that the "*vital principle*" and "*nerve aura*" are one and the same element; but when we find a force which produces upon the organism the effects which we attribute to the "vital prineiple," when we find that force capable of moving the muscles, stimulating the circulation, promoting digestion and respiration, and acting even upon the nervous system itself, are we not justified in assuming that such force is one and the same with the "*vital principle*"? We have a sufficient array of phenomena, through whatever media we observe the action of electricity, to determine that it is the true motor of vital force, and that the physiologist who carefully observes its working as a therapeutic agent, and the anatomist who watches its effects even upon dead matter, have plausible reason to assume that they approach a solution of the problem of life.

Mr. St. Clair Gray published in 1872 a paper upon the origin of nerve-force, which he illustrated by what he considers to be a newly discovered source of natural electricity. During some of his experiments he prepared a cell or cup, containing a solution of caustic potash, in which sticks of phosphorus and sulphur were placed; within half an hour the sulphur was apparently unaffected, the phosphorus was reduced to an oily mass at the bottom of the cell. After a time, it was ascertained that several salts of potassium occurred in the solution, and that